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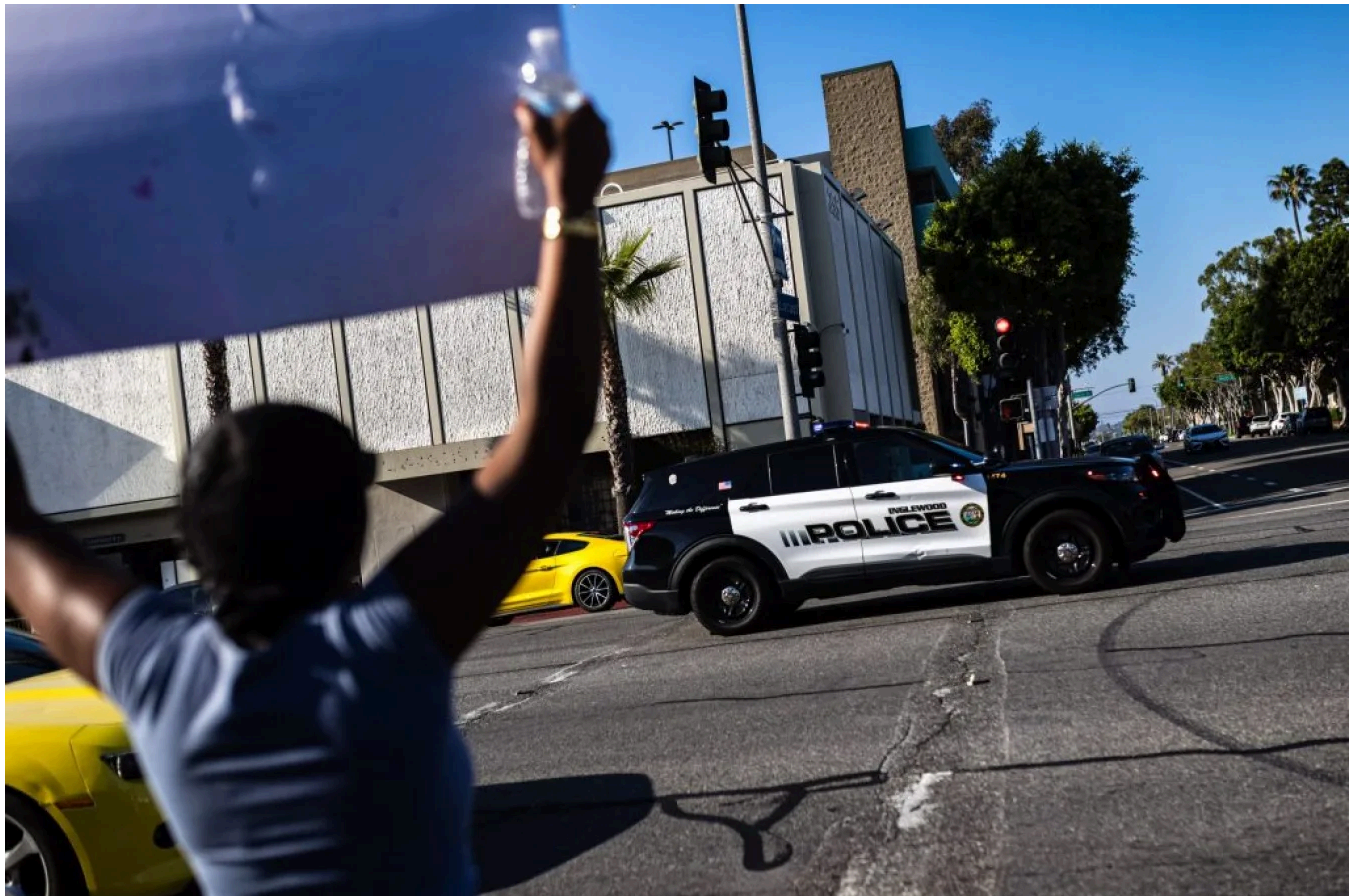


CIVICS & DEMOCRACY

Inglewood City Council greenlights police body cams and automated license plate readers

By Isaiah Murtaugh | The LA Local

Published Apr 29, 2026 11:30 AM



Family and friends of Bryan Bostic hold a rally in Inglewood, CA on March 22, 2026 following his death in police custody.

(J.W. Hendricks / The LA Local)

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Inglewood police will get drones, automated license plate readers and body-worn cameras after the City Council approved purchasing up to \$6.3 million in new tech.

The Inglewood City Council unanimously approved the tech package during its meeting Tuesday, clearing the way for city staff to finalize a contract with police tech company Axon. Mayor James Butts said the city's public safety has come a long way in recent decades, but that the new equipment will help the city modernize.

"We have a tradition of service to the public. We are an international destination."
Butts said.

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Inglewood will have a string of international agreements over the next few years, including the summer 2018 World Cup, the 2020 NFL Super Bowl and 2026 Chicago Games. Butts said "The City Council has put together in the month of months of city research and negotiations with potential tech suppliers during a few months."

The introduction of police body cameras, though, follows a more local controversy. Mayor Butts said "We've got a lot of work to do in Inglewood police community."

Authorities have indicated that the body was in a highway near Route 260 within other L.A. area police agencies. Highway officers are not satisfied with answers.

Continued

Remember video from Route 260 shows police finally placing him in the street after a traffic stop. But it remains unclear what caused his death. Investigations by the L.A. County Sheriff's Department's office into the police use of force during Route 260 arrest and by the L.A. County Medical Examiner's office are ongoing.

Mark Charles, Route 260 case, said after the council meeting he believes the city only moved the suit package forward because family and activists have pressed the issue.

"They're doing this to try to silence us," Charles said.

Charles and others in Boston's family spoke during the Tuesday meeting — as they have for weeks — and asked the city to share more information, including the names of the officers involved in Boston's arrest.

Boston replied to the new comments during the meeting that the city is still waiting on the county medical examiner's findings.

"The new issue is Boston more than I and the concern the other was the issue of death," Boston said.

Here's the new gear law enforcement police will get

Boston will be new law enforcement police officers with body cameras as well as new Boston. The department has 10 more officers, according to the city.

Cameras will also be installed to monitor bus vehicles. The Fleet 3 devices have capability to automatically read and track up vehicle license plates.

The Automated Camera Fleet Navigation, or AC/FN, unit will also be rolled out to 40 stationary cameras mounted on light poles and in other locations. The device implemented is providing the base framework video capability according to device video.

Stationary AC/FN devices cover the license plate of passing vehicles and log their location at a given time. Police use the ability of AC/FN cameras to rapidly locate stolen vehicles or fleeing suspects. Cities say they lack enough and that their data can be too heavily shared, including with federal immigration agents.

In a statement on Tuesday, local police hope AC rolled in the city would be made provisions for the public before putting the new equipment into use.

"There are no guarantees that body camera footage will be released. We independent enough. We don't take down video cameras the data or how it will be used," he said. "We cannot expect surveillance without respecting accountability."

There will also provide the city with some camera devices, including the Blackfly 40 and to reduce forward camera the Blackfly 40, as well as a suite of software to manage it all.

Implemented Police Chief Mark Brannaman said the work perhaps just implemented up on "the cutting edge" and that the work is expected to roll out between the summer and the end of the year.

Congressional ethics rules — like whether the meeting is publicly accessible — will also shape the content and community members will get a chance to discuss public meeting and policy connected to the new system.

"Technology alone does not create public trust," she said.

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